The Marketing Engine, Explained Simply

The same four engines from 'The Marketing Engine' document — told as one month in the life of a business, so the flow diagrams make sense.

Companion to: Vinayak_Marketing_Engine.pdf · July 2026

Read me first

The main document explains four 'engines' with formulas and flow diagrams. This one explains the same thing with a story. The business and the numbers below are made up (but realistic) so we can follow one clean example from start to finish. Wherever the story says **[DIAGRAM]**, that moment is one box in the main document's flow diagrams — a small map at the end shows which box is which.

Meet the business

Mahesh runs a brush factory. He sells to 32 shops and distributors. He knows his top five customers by heart — he speaks to them weekly. The other 27? He sees their names when invoices are made, and that's it. Mahesh is not lazy; he simply has one head, and it is full. His software (TranzAct) records every invoice faithfully — and nobody ever reads those records twice.

The whole idea in one line: our system reads those records every morning, notices what Mahesh would notice if he had 32 heads, and asks his permission to act on it.

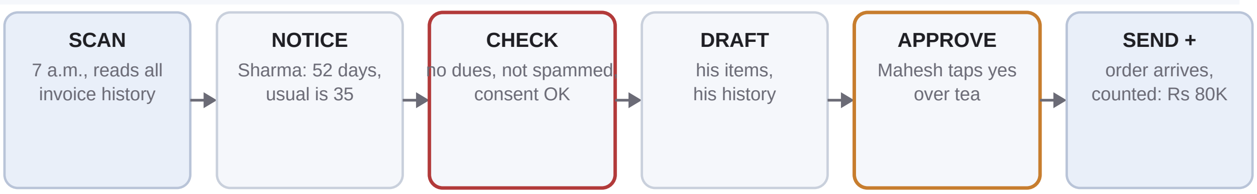
Week 1 — The forgotten Friday order (Engine 1: Reorder Radar)

Sharma Hardware has ordered brushes from Mahesh every 35 days or so, for two years. It is now day 52 since their last order. No one in Mahesh's office has noticed — why would they? An order that doesn't arrive makes no sound.

Tuesday, 7 a.m. — the system does its daily scan **[DIAGRAM: 'Daily scan']**. It computes every customer's personal rhythm from their own invoices: Sharma's is 35 days **[DIAGRAM: 'Rhythm math']**. 52 > 35 x 1.5, so Sharma gets flagged, along with the money at stake — their usual order is about Rs 80,000. Next, the safety checks **[DIAGRAM: 'Guardrails']**: does Sharma owe overdue money? No. Did we message them recently? No. Do we have consent to message them? Yes. Cleared.

The system writes a short message — not a generic blast, but Sharma-specific: it names the items they always buy and their last order date **[DIAGRAM: 'Draft nudge']**. The draft lands in Mahesh's approval inbox. Over morning tea, he reads it, changes one word, and taps Approve **[DIAGRAM: 'Owner approves' — the orange box; nothing ever sends without this tap]**. The email goes out **[DIAGRAM: 'Send']**.

Thursday, Sharma's purchase manager replies: "Arre, completely slipped my mind — send the usual." The order is entered in TranzAct like always — Sharma doesn't need to learn anything new **[DIAGRAM: 'Dealer orders']**. Within the hour, our sync sees the new invoice, matches it to the nudge, and marks the loop closed **[DIAGRAM: 'Counted']**. Rs 80,000 that was drifting away, back on schedule.



Why this matters beyond one order: a skipped cycle is often a competitor's trial. The nudge didn't just recover Rs 80,000 — it interrupted a new habit before it formed.

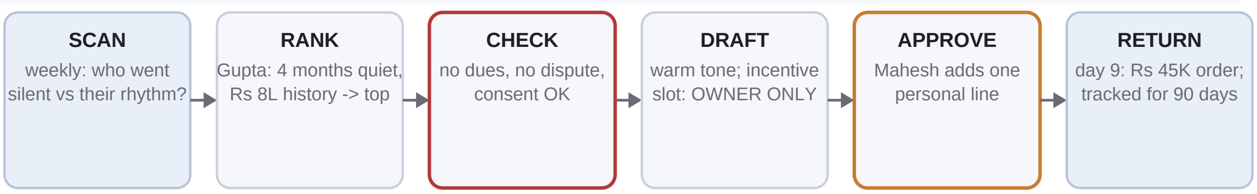
Week 2 — The customer everyone forgot (Engine 2: Win-Back)

Gupta Distributors bought Rs 8 lakh of brushes over three years — then went silent four months ago. Nobody decided to lose Gupta. There was no fight, no complaint. A late delivery annoyed them, a competitor's salesman visited the next day, and habit did the rest. In Mahesh's head, Gupta is still 'a customer'. In reality, Gupta is gone — and nobody has noticed.

The weekly scan compares every customer's silence against their own old rhythm. Gupta used to order monthly; four months of silence is four missed cycles — flagged, and ranked near the top of the win-back list because of their Rs 8L history (a big lost customer outranks a small one). The guardrails check their account: no unpaid dues, no dispute on record. Safe to approach.

The draft is warmer than a nudge: it references the relationship, not just products. The system NEVER invents a discount — there is a blank slot where only Mahesh can type an incentive. He decides: no discount, but he adds one personal line — "Gupta ji, it's been too long. Chai is on me next time you're in Delhi." Approve. Send.

A week passes. Nothing. (This is normal — win-backs are slower than nudges.) Day 9: an order for Rs 45,000 arrives. The system marks Gupta 'reactivated' and quietly keeps watching — every Gupta order for the next 90 days is tracked as recovered revenue. One approved message; a Rs 8L-history relationship breathing again.



Win-back is the cheapest revenue there is: the relationship, trust and credit history are already paid for. One message versus months of sales visits for a new account of the same size.

Week 3 — The product they never knew you sold (Engine 3: Cross-Sell)

Mahesh's factory makes 124 products. His average customer buys just 6 of them. Where do those customers buy the other things they need? Somewhere else — often only because nobody ever told them Mahesh makes those too.

The monthly scan looks for patterns ACROSS customers: shops that buy paint brushes almost always also buy rollers — 9 out of 11 of them do. But five customers buy lots of paint brushes and have never once bought a roller. Those five are the audience. The message is specific and gives its reason: "Most of our paint-brush customers also take our rollers — should we add two boxes to your next order to try?" Mahesh approves (he can veto pairs that don't make trade sense — he knows things the data doesn't).

Two of the five say yes. Small orders — Rs 6,000 each. But here is the compounding part: a customer who buys 7 product lines instead of 6 is not just 15% more revenue — he is harder for a competitor to poach, because switching suppliers now means replacing seven things, not six. Depth is defence.

SCAN monthly: what do baskets have in common? → **PATTERN** brush buyers usually buy rollers too → **FIND GAP** 5 buy brushes, never tried rollers → **CHECK** stock available? credit OK? → **APPROVE** Mahesh can veto odd pairings → **NEW LINE** 2 of 5 try rollers; only roller Rs counted

Honest accounting: only the ROLLER revenue is credited to this engine — not the whole invoice. Each engine is only allowed to claim what it actually caused.

Week 4 — The shelf that eats money (Engine 4: Stock & Season Push)

In the warehouse sits Rs 60,000 of white bristle brushes — unsold since February. The finance dashboard already flags this as 'trapped capital' (money frozen on a shelf). This engine gives that flag hands: it finds the 8 customers who historically buy that category, Mahesh sets a clearance price himself (the system never discounts on its own), and an offer goes to exactly those 8 — nobody else. Three take it. Rs 34,000 of frozen money becomes invoices, and shelf space becomes free.

FLAG Rs 60K stock idle since February → **MATCH** the 8 shops that buy this category → **PRICE** Mahesh sets the offer himself → **SEND** offer to those 8 only → **MOVED** 3 take it: Rs 34K unfrozen

Month end — the page that proves it wasn't luck

At the end of the month Mahesh gets one page. It says: 34 messages approved, 19 customers ordered, Rs 11.4 lakh of orders from messaged customers. But the page also shows a stranger, more honest number: **Rs 6.2 lakh incremental** — and this is the number that matters.

The hold-back trick, explained with two plants

How do we know Sharma wouldn't have ordered anyway? For one customer, we can't. So we do what a gardener does to test a fertilizer: feed one plant, don't feed the other, compare. Every campaign deliberately does NOT message a random 20% of its audience (the 'hold-back' group). At month end we compare: messaged customers ordered Rs 100 on average; held-back customers ordered Rs 40 on average. The Rs 60 difference is what the messages caused - it cannot be the season, the market, or luck, because both groups lived through the same season, market and luck. The only difference between them was our messages.

That's why the pitch says 'provably increases revenue'. Not a promise — a measurement Mahesh can check against his own books.

How to read the flow diagrams in the main document

What you see	What it means
A box	One step the system takes, in order, left to right
An arrow	The output of one step feeding the next
The ORANGE box	The human gate: nothing is sent, ever, without the owner tapping Approve
The RED-bordered box	The guardrails: skip customers with unpaid dues, respect the 14-day message cap, respect consent
The last (blue) box	The proof step: the result is counted from the business's own invoices, automatically
Two rows	Top row = the system thinking; bottom row = the action and the result

The month, added up

Engine	What happened	Money
Reorder Radar	Sharma's forgotten order recovered	Rs 80,000
Win-Back	Gupta reactivated (day 9), tracked 90 days	Rs 45,000 +
Cross-Sell	2 customers added a new product line	Rs 12,000
Stock Push	Frozen stock turned into invoices	Rs 34,000
	Owner's total effort: a few minutes of approvals per day	*~Rs 1.7L touched*

One honest footnote: the story's numbers are illustrative, and with ~32 customers the early hold-back comparisons are rough — the proof gets sharper every month and with every new business onboarded. What is NOT illustrative: the patterns. The real kbrushes data already shows 6 regulars past their reorder window and 15 lapsed customers — Sharma and Gupta exist; they just have different names.